The Communion is a syncretic temple and the official faith of the Northern Morivian Empire. Its beliefs are centered around the one true god, The First Mother, who is responsible for creating the universe, but is also asleep and withdrawn from her creation.

Before The First Mother, everything existed together. Then she separated: light from dark, heaven from land, living from dead, memory from forgetting. But separating is not the same as dividing. For those who do not believe, this distinction is irrelevant, but for those who do believe, it is foundational to seeing the universe. Everything still retains a connection to everything else.

Death, therefore, is not annihilation, but rather a change in where a person belongs. They are separated from the living, and become part of the ancestral world.

Some people are blessed with the gift of continuity. Families will have members across generations who grow to look identical. Birth marks will appear and reappear. And some individuals even remember things they did not experience with their own bodies. The individuals most gifted with continuity are called Living Saints.

There are three Living Saints, who represent three Ways of Returning. Sallus Ven, who represents continuity, is concerned with the relationships between generations, laws, inheritance, marriage, birth, and naming. Trinivar, who represents memory, deals in history, prophecy, revelation, dreams, and forbidden knowledge. Vespera, who represents action, is associated with protection, warfare, exploration, construction, and the practical application of sacred knowledge.

The Living Saints are venerated in the Communion Temple as its worldly figureheads. They are recursive figures. More than just a single person, they are a soul that returns in each generation to inhabit a vessel and provide guidance to the faithful. When one saint's vessel perishes, a new one is anointed, and the saint returns.

Different groups have different relationships with the Communion. The more cosmopolitan Bastion Morivians and residents of the imperial heartlands are temple hardliners; they follow the words and scriptures of the Living Saints, participate in the temple ceremonies and holidays, and forge strong communities around their local temples. Their relationship with faith is centralized, structured, and formal.

The Bastionless Morivians, that is, those who do not live in the imperial cities or heartlands, have a more personal approach to the temple. They honor and follow the teachings of the Living Saints, but may not be as aware of the scriptures and language used by the temple. They broadly believe all the same things as the Bastion Morivians, but don't consider the procedures and cadences of prayers and ceremonies to be essential to living a faithful life.

The Va'a, the Morivians who live beyond the influence of the empire, believe in the teachings of the Saints, but largely reject their divinity. They call The First Mother "Umma," and instead turn toward ancestral worship as a means of strengthening community through faith. They keep

shrines full of heirlooms, and carry the bones of their loved ones to the burning equator, the lost ancestral Morivian homeland. Their histories mention the existence of two additional Living Saints, often called the Unmourned, and account for a number of missing stories from the texts of the temple. These beliefs are heretical to the temple, and, for this very reason, the practices of the Va'a are banned within the empire.

There are countless other groups around the fringes who interact with faith in Hiraeth in completely different ways. The Alismana believe in The First Mother, whom they call "Iran'Husu,", but reject the Living Saints. They gather their dead in the Glass Garden, far north beyond where others may travel, where they await the reawakening of Iran'Husu to enjoin all the souls of past generations in eternal life.

The Tuar worship their nameless First Mother through song and smoke. They intend to reawaken her through their collective voices so that she may retake control of the infinite sky to give them sun when it is desired and rain when it is needed. They make new songs to worship by in smoke lodges, where high temperatures and collective hallucinations foment subconscious revelations.

The Volk do not believe in the First Mother. They believe in the Redwood, the creeping red vine that possesses the earth and its flora. Where the Redwood spreads, it destroys the weak and leaves behind only the things which gain its favor. The Volk are one such favored group, for they alone can eat the fruits of tainted plants in the Redwood. They do not believe in personal possessions